Assessment 1: Data Journalism Article

Length	1,000 words ± 10%, not including the reference list.
Deadline	[Insert date and time.]
Weighting	35% of the overall module grade.
Submission	One PDF, uploaded to Canvas.

Your task

Write a **1,000-word data journalism article** using data from **YouGov's political trackers.**

Choose your own question and data. Use R to conduct your analysis and include **at least one** original figure created using `ggplot2`. You may include more than one figure if you like.

Refer to **at least two academic journal articles or academic books.** Use them to explain the issue or interpret your findings, either by including a quote or citing them and linking to the original source.

Write for **a general audience:** someone who is interested in politics but has no training in data science.

What to submit

Submit **one PDF** containing your student ID, your work, word count, and reference list. Do not include your name. Use your student ID as the filename and the submission title. Do not submit your data.

Writing your article

- **Establish the question and why it matters.** Use a headline that identifies your question or main finding. Link your topic to contemporary events.
- **Build a clear argument.** Use short paragraphs to explain how the evidence answers your question.
- **Put your findings in context.** Explain what each figure means for your argument and cite published academic research to explain or interpret your findings.
- **Give a clear, qualified answer.** Explain what the data show and what they leave unresolved.

Analysing your data

If you need some help getting started, you can return to the materials from Workshops 1–4 and work through the tasks again using the data you have chosen:

- **Workshop 1:** Download and import your YouGov data into R.
- **Workshop 2:** Inspect, prepare, and clean your data.
- **Workshop 3:** Summarise your data and identify a finding.
- **Workshop 4:** Create and export your figure(s) using `ggplot2`.

Discussing data and figures

Mention where your data come from, what they measure, the population and dates that they cover, and the sample size. Explain any choices that might affect how you interpret your results, such as combining responses or excluding observations.

Make sure that each figure has a clear title, readable labels, units, and dates or groups as appropriate. Make clear what the data source is in a caption. Export the figure using `ggsave` and insert the rendered file into your article. **Do not** use screenshots of RStudio or copy figures from other publications.

Sources and references

Refer to academic research to support your argument or contextualise your findings. For example, you could quote from a study or describe its findings in your own words and link to the original source:

Quotation: Ralph Scott, a political scientist at the University of Bristol, finds that achieving a degree "reduces authoritarianism and racial prejudice".

Paraphrase with a link: Research by Ralph Scott, a political scientist at the University of Bristol, found that university graduates became more socially liberal, but also more right-wing in their economic views.

In-text citations — e.g. Scott (2022) — are not required, but you must include a **reference list** at the end of your article. List every academic source that you use, giving the author, date, title, publication or website, and a link. Use the Harvard referencing format for your reference list. For example:

Scott, R. (2022). 'Does university make you more liberal? Estimating the within-individual effects of higher education on political values', *Electoral Studies*, 77, 102471. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2022.102471.

How your work will be assessed

Your final mark will reflect:

- The **clarity** of your argument and the **relevance** of your question.
- The **accuracy** of your analysis and the **presentation** of your figure(s).
- The **interpretation** of your findings, their political significance, and their limitations.
- The **quality** of your writing and your use of **academic** references.

Getting help

- **Assessment-support session:** In Workshop 5 in teaching Week 6, you can get started on your assignment in class with help from your workshop tutor.
- **Office hours:** Book an appointment with me or your workshop tutor for help with your question, data analysis, or a draft. You can find booking links and assessment guidance on Canvas.

For technical problems with submission, contact Student Support.

Note that **we cannot grant extensions**. Contact Student Support to request one.